

Contemporaneous meeting notes for use with other resources in preparation of draft minutes
MEMBERS – PERSONS appearing – BRIEF DESCRIPTION – DECISIONS. RSA 91-A:2.

The Claremont City Council held a meeting on Wednesday, October 8, 2025, in the Council Chambers of City Hall.

The meeting was called to order by Mayor Girard at 6:30 p.m.

Members of the Council present:

Ward I Councilor Andrew O’Hearne
Ward II Councilor Brian Zutter
Ward III Councilor Jonathan Hayden
Assistant Mayor Debora Matteau
At-Large Councilor William Greenrose
At-Large Councilor Wayne Hemingway
At-Large Councilor William Limoges
At-Large Councilor Nicholas Koloski
Mayor Dale Girard

Also present:

Nancy Bates, City Manager

Councilor Zutter joined the meeting at 6:39pm

AGENDA CHANGES

REPORT OF THE SECRETARY

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Hemingway to accept the minutes of the September 24, 2025 as amended, City Council meeting.

Councilor Greenrose requested the Energy Advisory Committee be specified under committee reports.

Councilor O’Hearne needs an E at the end of his name on page 5.

Voice vote:

Koloski – yes

Greenrose – yes

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Limoges - yes

Matteau – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

O’Hearne – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 8-0

MAYOR’S NOTES

Proclamation – Domestic Violence Awareness Month

Mayor Girard read Proclamation

Turning points thanked the mayor and council.

Saturday October 11th and Sunday October 12th the wheelhouse and Arc are hosting the EEC.

Claremont Parks and Recreation will be hosting a Food truck festival Saturday October 11th and Sunday October 12th at the Claremont Middle school from 11:00 a.m to 7:00 p.m.

Saturday October 18th the rail trail rendezvous will start at the Community Center to Protectworth brewing. There will be live music from 12:30p.m. to 3:30p.m. with a free shuttle from 3:30p.m. to 5:30p.m. which will return you to the starting point at the Community Center.

Saturday October 18th 19th the Parks and Recreation department will host a softball tournament to benefit the Claremont schools.

Councilor Koloski mentions the Fireman’s parade Friday October 10th at 6:30p.m.

CITY MANAGER’S REPORT

General Remarks

The Police department Bike auction will be held at broad street park Saturday October 11th starting at 9a.m.

The Community center has started to post Monday clips in collaboration with Fourth Kind Films.

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Several RFP's about to be posted on the city website.

Welcome Annie Steed started on Monday as the new Planning Director. The city will hold a meet and greet next week.

Director Steed came to introduce herself. Expresses her excitement to be apart of the community of Claremont.

Merchant McIntyre Fall 2025 Presentation

Tristan and Yasmine presented a PowerPoint for the council.

Tristan opened the floor for questions from the council.

Councilor Greenrose inquired about numbers from last year comparing to this year.

Tristan explained numbers are well aligned with what was expected, even more encouraging this year.

APPOINTMENT TO BOARDS AND COMMITTEES

Fiske Free Library Board of Trustees

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Limoges to appoint Chiara Tosi-Nelson to Seat A-1 on the Fiske Free Library Board of Trustees

Roll call:

Koloski – yes

Greenrose – yes

Limoges - yes

Matteau – yes

Zutter – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

O'Hearne – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 9-0

A motion was made by Councilor Limoges and seconded by Councilor Zutter to appoint Arthur Vidro to Seat 5 on the Fiske Free Library Board of Trustees

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Roll call:

Koloski – yes
Greenrose – yes
Limoges - yes
Matteau – yes
Zutter – yes
Hemingway – yes
Hayden – yes
O’Hearne – yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 9-0

Parks and Recreation Commission

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Zutter to appoint Sheila Rook to Seat 4 – At Large on the Parks and Recreation Commission.

Roll call:

Koloski – yes
Greenrose – yes
Limoges - yes
Matteau – yes
Zutter – yes
Hemingway – yes
Hayden – yes
O’Hearne – yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 9-0

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Councilor O’Hearne to appoint Michael Theroux to Alternate Seat 2 -Ward II on the Parks and Recreation Commission.

Roll call:

Koloski – yes
Greenrose – yes
Limoges - yes
Matteau – yes
Zutter – yes
Hemingway – yes
Hayden – yes
O’Hearne – yes
Girard – yes

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Motion carried 9-0

CITIZEN'S FORUM

Mayor Girard opened the forum at 6:52

Sean McCarthy ward 1 – Mr. McCarthy voiced he would like to see the veterans' deduction raised from \$500.00 to \$700.00. Mr. McCarthy also mentioned Monadnock park could use less of a descend also solar lights in the openings of the gates with larger ways to get through. School board resigned. Reached out to literature, was directed to come speak to city council. Asking for help to enforce these laws. Expressed unhappiness.

Chris Cogswell Ward 3 - Mr. Cogswell came to speak on his platform for at large Council seat he is running for.

Mayor Girard closed citizen's forum at 6:59.

OLD BUSINESS

NEW BUSINESS

Ordinance 641 Veterans Tax Credit – First Reading

Councilor Hemingway recused himself.

Mr. Hamilton explains Ordinance 641.

Councilor Greenrose inquiries about the math given the numbers.

Mr. Hamilton explains it would nominally amount of change.

CITY OF CLAREMONT – IN THE YEAR TWO THOUSAND AND TWENTY-FIVE

ORDINANCE #641

PROPERTY TAX CREDIT FOR VETERANS

The City of Claremont Ordains:

Pursuant to New Hampshire RSA 72:35, the Claremont City Code is hereby amended to revise Article II, Division 2 of Chapter 18 as follows:

Section 1. Property Tax Credit for Veterans

Sec. 18-44 Credit for totally disabled veterans.

Revise subsection (a) of Section 18-44 to increase the annual benefit, for a tax credit on real estate taxes owed, provided to qualified veterans or their surviving spouses, due to a recent statutory change that prohibits the “stacking” of this exemption with the veterans’ exemption set forth in RSA 72:28, so that the provision shall read as follows:

- (a) In accordance with RSA 72:35, the city shall provide any veteran who has been honorably discharged or an officer honorably separated from military service and who has a total and permanent service-connected disability, or who is a double amputee or paraplegic because of service-connected injury, or the surviving spouse of such person a credit each year from tax on his/her residential real estate in the amount of one thousand nine hundred dollars (\$1,900.00). Any individual who qualifies for and receives this tax credit shall not be eligible for the tax credit provided in Sec. 18-43 pursuant to the provisions of RSA 72:35.

Section 2. Prior Enactments Shall Not Be Superseded

Any adoptions and/or amendments to Chapter 18, Article II, Division 2, Section 18-44 of the City Code by action of the City Council, prior to adoption of this Ordinance, are hereby preserved subject to the current amendments as presented by this Ordinance.

Section 3. Validity

If any article, section, subsection, sentence, clause or phrase of this Ordinance is for any reason held to be unconstitutional or invalid, such decision shall not affect the remaining portions of this Ordinance.

Section 4. Effective Date

This Ordinance shall take effect for purposes of accepting applications under the increased credit amount immediately upon passage and any such approved tax credits, for said qualified veterans (or surviving spouse), shall be applied to the tax year commencing April 1, 2026.

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A motion was made by Councilor Limoges and seconded by Councilor Greenrose to approve Ordinance 641.

Roll Call:

Koloski – Yes

Greenrose – Yes

Limoges - Yes

Matteau – Yes

Zutter – Yes

Hemingway – recused

Hayden – Yes

O’Hearne – Yes

Girard – Yes

Motion carried 8-0-1

Ordinance 642 Elderly Tax Exemption – First Reading

Mr Hamilton explains ordinance 642.

CITY OF CLAREMONT – IN THE YEAR TWO THOUSAND AND TWENTY-FIVE

ORDINANCE #642

PROPERTY TAX EXEMPTIONS FOR ELDERLY

The City of Claremont Ordains:

Pursuant to New Hampshire RSA 72:27-a, RSA 72-39-a and RSA 72-39-b, the Claremont City Code is hereby amended to revise Article II, Division 4 of Chapter 18 as follows:

Section 1. Property Tax Exemption for Elderly

Sec. 18-58 (4). Exemption amount and qualifications.

Revise Subsection (4) of Section 18-58 to increase the qualifying net income and asset limits so that the provision shall read as follows:

(4) To qualify, an unmarried taxpayer must have a net income of not more than twenty-eight thousand four hundred dollars (\$28,400.00), or if married, must have a combined net

income of not more than thirty-seven thousand five hundred dollars (\$37,500.00). Net assets for either an unmarried taxpayer or, if married, combined assets must be not more than seventy-seven thousand six hundred dollars (\$77,600.00), exclusive of the value of the taxpayer's residence and the land upon which it is located up to the greater of two (2) acres or the minimum single-family residential lot specified in the Claremont Zoning Ordinance for the zone in which the property lies. The combined net asset amount shall apply to a surviving spouse until the sale or transfer of the property by the surviving spouse or until the remarriage of the surviving spouse.

Section 2. Prior Enactments Shall Not Be Superseded

Any adoptions and/or amendments to Chapter 18, Article II, Division 4, Section 18-58 of the City Code by action of the City Council, prior to adoption of this Ordinance, are hereby preserved subject to the current amendments as presented by this Ordinance.

Section 3. Validity

If any article, section, subsection, sentence, clause or phrase of this Ordinance is for any reason held to be unconstitutional or invalid, such decision shall not affect the remaining portions of this Ordinance.

Section 4. Effective Date

This Ordinance shall take effect for purposes of accepting applications under the increased limits immediately upon passage and shall be enforced for property tax exemptions for the elderly for the tax year commencing April 1, 2026.

A motion was made by Councilor Hemingway and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to approve ordinance 642.

Mayor Girard asks how many people this can affect.

Mr. Hamilton responds most of the people who qualify are far below on the asset portion and threshold. There is not a large pool or very many people that have been impacted.

Roll Call:

Koloski – yes

Greenrose – yes

Limoges - yes

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Matteau – yes

Zutter – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

O’Hearne – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 9-0

Ordinance 643 Disabled Tax Exemption -First Reading

Mr. Hamilton explains Ordinance 643.

CITY OF CLAREMONT – IN THE YEAR TWO THOUSAND AND TWENTY-FIVE

ORDINANCE #643

PROPERTY TAX EXEMPTION FOR THE DISABLED

The City of Claremont Ordains:

Pursuant to New Hampshire RSA 72:27-a and RSA 72:37-b, the Claremont City Code is hereby amended to revise Article II, Division 3 of Chapter 18 as follows:

Section 1. Property Tax Exemption for the Disabled

Sec. 18-53. Exemption for the disabled.

Revise Subsections (a), (2) and (3) of Section 18-53 to modify net income and asset qualification standards to read as follows:

- (a) In accordance with New Hampshire RSA 72:37-b, the city shall provide for the exemption for disabled persons from property tax, that every inhabitant who is entitled shall be granted a thirty-five thousand dollars (\$35,000.00) property value exemption based upon the following additional eligibility criteria:
 - (2) Applicant must have had, in the calendar year preceding April 1 of the year in which the exemption is claimed, an annual net income from all sources of less than twenty-

five thousand four hundred dollars (\$25,400.00), if single, [or] a combined annual net income of less than thirty-four thousand three hundred dollars (\$34,300.00), if married. Such net income is to be determined by deducting from all monies received from any source whatsoever the amount or sum of any life insurance paid on the death of an insured, expenses and costs incurred in the course of conducting a business enterprise, [and/or] proceeds from the sale of assets; and

- (3) Applicant's net assets, as defined in RSA 72:37-b III(b), excluding the value of the residence and the land upon which it is located up to the greater of two (2) acres or the minimum single family residential lot size for that zone as specified in the city's zoning ordinance, must not exceed forty-five thousand three hundred dollars (\$45,300.00).

Section 2. Prior Enactments Shall Not Be Superseded

Any adoptions and/or amendments to Chapter 18, Article II, Division 3, Section 18-53 of the City Code by action of the City Council, prior to adoption of this Ordinance, are hereby preserved subject to the current amendments as presented by this Ordinance.

Section 3. Validity

If any article, section, subsection, sentence, clause or phrase of this Ordinance is for any reason held to be unconstitutional or invalid, such decision shall not affect the remaining portions of this Ordinance.

Section 4. Effective Date

This Ordinance shall take effect for purposes of accepting applications under the increased limits immediately upon passage and shall be enforced for property tax exemptions for the disabled for the tax year commencing April 1, 2026.

A motion was made by Councilor Hayden and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to approve Ordinance 643.

Councilor Hayden asks if applicants can stack with elderly benefit.

Mr Hamilton states one or the other.

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Councilor Koloski asks what is the best way for people to find this information.

Mr. Hamilton responds to Councilor Koloski that the city website on assessing, all items are listed.

Mr. Hamilton encourages anyone who has questions to call or come in . the office has several options for the residents.

Councilor Hemingway brought thinking about widgets that would be on the website for estimate on what the resident may qualify for.

Voice vote:

Koloski – yes

Greenrose – yes

Limoges - yes

Matteau – yes

Zutter – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

O’Hearne – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 9-0

Conduit License Agreement for Valley Regional Hospital

Brief discussion followed.

Motion to Approve License for Underground Conduit in City Right-of-Way

The Claremont City Council hereby authorizes the City Manager, or her designees, to negotiate and enter into a License Agreement with Valley Regional Hospital (hereinafter VRH) for non-exclusive use of a designated portion of the City's public right-of-way across and beneath sidewalks and paved and unpaved portions of roadway on Elm Street for the laying of conduit and installation of fiber optic cabling, wiring and electronic infrastructure for VRH’s private use. This license shall be effective only

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upon receipt by VRH of all permits and approvals as may be required, including approval as to location by the City's Director of Public Works, and in compliance with all applicable codes and regulations. This license shall also be personal to VRH, with any subsequent owner being required to request a new license from the Council, with such approval to not unreasonably be withheld. VRH shall be responsible for all costs incurred by the City related to construction and maintenance of the facilities placed in and under City-owned property, including but not limited to restoring City-owned property to its preconstruction condition. The City Council further authorizes the City Manager, or her designees, to undertake all actions and to execute all documents as may be required to implement this motion.

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Councilor Zutter to accept the motion.

Voice vote:

Koloski – yes

Greenrose – yes

Limoges - yes

Matteau – yes

Zutter – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

O’Hearne – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 9-0

Resolution 2026-18 Authorization to Apply NBRC Sugar River Revitalization Project

Manager Bates explains Resolution, the amount and application process.

Nancy explains the amount and application process

Councilor Hemingway inquires how would the match funding work in kind or funds.

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Tristan explains as currently drafted mix of in-kind and cash.

RESOLUTION 2026-18

NBRC Grant – Sugar River Revitalization

BE IT RESOLVED by the Claremont City Council, after a public hearing duly noticed, that:

WHEREAS the City Council approves the application for up to \$430,000 in grant funds from Northern Borders Regional Commission (NBRC) to be used for the Sugar River Revitalization and Brownfields Redevelopment Project, with a 20% project match by the City; and

WHEREAS if the City is awarded the NBRC grant funds, the City Council will accept the funds for their intended purpose;

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED THAT if the City is awarded the NBRC grant funds the City Council will expend up to \$430,000.00 in grant funding, and 20% in City matching funds, to support the Sugar River Revitalization and Brownfields Redevelopment Project;

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED THAT the City Manager or her designee is hereby authorized to apply for, accept, and expend grant funds from the Northern Borders Regional Commission (NBRC), and to sign all NBRC investment documents that bind the applicant. *(2/3 Vote Required)*.

Dated this 8th day of October 2025, the City of Claremont, County of Sullivan, State of New Hampshire.

A motion was made by Councilor Hemingway and seconded by Councilor Koloski to accept Resolution 2026-18.

Manager Bates adds foot note she is pursuing other funding.

Public hearing 7:34pm

No one spoke closed 7:34pm

Voice vote:

Koloski – yes

Greenrose – yes

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Limoges - yes

Matteau – yes

Zutter – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

O’Hearne – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 9-0

COMMITTEE REPORTS

Councilor Limoges – CDA – questions on renter 56, all to date. Blanc and Bailey are doing the work over there. Realter for industrial park. Solar project is moving forward.

Councilor Zutter – CCTV – shared video on demand 2023-2024 numbers more robust schedule 75%, 66% overall based on number viewers.

FUTURE AGENDA ITEMS AND DIRECTIVES

Councilor Hayden inquired about Broad Street Cemetery.

Manager Bates is actively working with the cemetery department.

Councilor Koloski inquiries about In house of control of climate.

Councilor Koloski inquires about the rail trail railing part of an insurance claim. Asking to fix the railing and try to get the funding after.

Councilor O’Hearne Main St. construction suggestion of flashing stop sign.

Councilor Hayden mentions website for planning and development misinformation for contacts for the office and dead links.

Councilor Limoges would like to see the council packet broken up.

Councilor Koloski mentions exhausts systems that are going around the city. Asks for clarification on ordinance and what can be done.

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Manager Bates responds to Councilor Koloski, she will research what can be done.

CONSULTATION WITH LEGAL COUNSEL

ADJOURNMENT

At 7:49 p.m., a motion was made by Councilor O’Hearne and seconded by Councilor Limoges to adjourn.

Voice vote:

Koloski – yes

Greenrose – yes

Limoges - yes

Matteau – yes

Zutter – yes

Hemingway –

Hayden – yes

O’Hearne – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 9-0

Respectfully Submitted,

Jaime DeRosa

Acting Clerk to the Council